DO YOU KNOW?

Food insecurity means having limited or uncertain availability of nutritionally adequate and safe foods or a limited ability to acquire appropriate foods.

- Weather conditions should also be considered-in hot season more of liquid should be included.
- Snacky meals should be given at intervals which can be easy to handle.
- Fruits and dry fruits can be given for snacks.

6.4 PACKED LUNCH: GUIDELINES FOR PREPARING NUTRITIOUS PACKED LUNCH FOR SCHOOL CHILDREN

Packed lunch has become a necessity for school children as it is not possible to have lunch at home. Packed lunch is a lunch in a tiffin box to be eaten by the child while away from home.

Points to be considered while planning packed lunches are:

1. It should meet one third of the day's nutritional requirements.
2. It should include food from all the four food groups though the number of dishes may be less.
3. Food stuffs providing good quality protein like egg, milk or milk products like paneer or curd would improve overall protein quality in combination with vegetable protein.
4. At least one serving of green leafy vegetables should be included.
5. One fruit or vegetable salad may be included every day.
6. Variety should be present.
7. Preferably the food packed should be different from that prepared for breakfast.
8. The dishes should be packed in the right consistency so as to avoid leakage or food becoming dry during lunch which may not be appetising to the child.
9. Following are two examples of a packed lunch.
   - Vegetable peas pulao, onion raita, boiled egg, banana.
   - Vegetable dhal rice, amaranth porial, soya gravy, and butter milk.

Activity 4

Match the following:

Vitamin A	tomato
Calcium	lemon
Iron	carrot
Vitamin D	liver
Vitamin C	milk
Lycopene	sunshine vitamin

2. List out the junk foods that are liked by school going children

6.5 NUTRITIONAL REQUIREMENTS DURING ADOLESCENCE

Adolescents is the period between childhood and adulthood. It is a period of rapid growth after infancy and it reaches its peak between 11th to 14th years for girls and 13th to 16th years for boys. Adolescence require more food for the following reasons:

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